HOW THE YEAR 2023 PANNED OUT FOR PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA MODI AND INDIA

Abrogation of Article 370 Validated



On December 11, the Supreme Court upheld the Modi government's August 2019 move to abrogate Article 370, which conferred special status on Jammu and Kashmir. The court validation brings a legal closure to the decades-old contentious issue

Heartland Wins



The BJP deployed its effective 'Modi ki Guarantee' among other strategic moves to clinch sweeping wins in Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan and Chhattisgarh in December, laying the groundwork for the upcoming 2024 Lok Sabha polls

Climate Warrior



At the COP28 that ended in Dubai on December 13, PM Modi secured a win for India and the developing economies. India advocated against rigid targets, ensuring flexibility in achieving the goal of tripling renewable energy capacity by 2030

Success in Space



In August, India achieved a historic milestone by successfully landing Chandrayaan-3 on the Moon's south pole, the first nation to do so. It has also opened up its space domain to private enterprises with the new Indian Space Policy

SETBACKS

Manipur Crisis



The Modi government faced flak for its handling of the escalating violence in the state. Despite the deaths and destruction which started in early May, the PM took 79 days to acknowledge the issue and, when he did, he focused on a viral video of two Kuki women who were paraded naked. The situation still remains volatile

Suspension of MPs



The winter session of Parliament will go down as one of the most ill-tempered—a security breach in the lower house, 146 MPs suspended for demanding a statement from the home minister, the Opposition's loud protests, the Centre acting with impunity, it was all a mess

Hitmen Scandal



The Modi regime faces accusations of targeting 'anti-India' individuals in the US and Canada. The latter named Indian agents in the September murder of Sikh radical Hardeep Singh Nijjar. Then the US alleged that a citizen, Gurpatwant Pannun, had also been targeted. India calls the charges "absurd, motivated"

Electoral Losses



The South is slipping away. In May, the BJP got a drubbing in its sole southern stronghold, Karnataka, with voters favouring the Congress. And in the recent assembly polls in Telangana, the party bettered its performance winning eight seats in the 119-member house, but many of its stalwart leaders fell by the wayside

agreements in defence, space and critical technology in July this year. This included setting up a co-production facility for manufacturing GE 414 jet engines for the Tejas Mk2 light combat aircraft. But there were also diplomatic setbacks. Canadian PM Justin Trudeau levelled embarrassing charges that an Indian government agent had abetted the killing of Canadian citizen Harjit Singh Nijjar, an alleged Sikh militant. The US government had a similar complaint about a plot to murder a US citizen, Gurpatwant Singh Pannun, another alleged Sikh radical. The Modi government has denied these charges and said India would investigate them if evidence was provided.

MASTER STRATEGIST

When it came to politics, Modi was the Master Strategist. At the start of 2023, the BJP showed signs of vincibility when the Congress, rejuvenated by Rahul Gandhi's Bharat Jodo Yatra, made a spirited comeback by winning assembly elections in Himachal Pradesh in December 2022, and Karnataka in May 2023. In July, a new threat to the BJP emerged with the formation of the Indian National Development Inclusive Alliance (INDIA), a 28-party coalition that included the Congress and all the major regional parties opposed to Modi. The glue was the potent narrative of increasing reservations for the Other Backward Classes (OBC), a Mandal 2.0, after Bihar chief minister Nitish Kumar unbottled his state's caste survey. It revealed that the OBCs constituted 65 per cent of the population but had a reservation quota of just 27 per cent. It was critical for Modi and the BJP to arrest the march of the Opposition by winning the battle for the Hindi heartland states of Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan and Chhattisgarh that went to the polls in November.

The BJP decided not to project any state leader and made Modi the party's prime mascot. He addressed as many as 34 rallies in these states. Sushil Kumar Modi, the former deputy chief minister of Bihar who was assigned to help in the